

Lab 2 – Agile Backlog Creation & Sprint Simulation

Project: OnCallOps (OCO)

Scenario: Incident Escalation & On-Call Rotation Engine

I. Reflection

1. Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

The Fibonacci story point estimates generally reflected the relative effort required for each user story. Smaller tasks such as viewing the on-call rotation and retrieving a post-mortem were assigned lower points, while tasks such as dispatching notifications, escalation, and creating a rotation schedule were assigned higher points. During the simulated sprint, the estimates provided a reasonable indication of the complexity of the work and helped in deciding how much work could be included in each sprint.

2. Was your backlog well-prioritized?

Yes, the backlog was prioritized according to the importance of each functionality to the incident management workflow. Core incident-handling functions such as receiving alerts, identifying the active on-call engineer, dispatching notifications, acknowledging incidents, and escalating unacknowledged incidents were given the highest priority. Rotation management was given high priority, while viewing schedules and maintaining post-mortem information were given medium priority. This ensured that the most critical functionality was addressed first.

3. How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

The simulated sprint broadly followed the planned order of implementation. Sprint 1 focused on the core incident alert handling workflow, starting from receiving an alert and identifying the on-call engineer through notification, acknowledgement, and escalation. Sprint 2 then focused on on-call rotation management and post-mortem functionality. Moving the stories through To Do, In Progress, In Review, and Done helped simulate the progress of a real Agile development team and showed how work can be tracked throughout a sprint.

4. What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

The burndown chart provided a visual representation of how quickly the planned story points were being completed during the sprint. It showed that the progress was gradual rather than all the work being completed at once. The chart also helped compare the remaining workload with the expected sprint progress and gave an indication of capacity. Overall, it demonstrated the usefulness of burndown charts for identifying whether a sprint is progressing as planned and for improving estimation and planning in future sprints.

II. EPICs

The project was divided into the following three major Epics:

1. **Incident Alert Handling**
Covers receiving incident alerts, identifying the active on-call engineer, dispatching notifications, acknowledging incidents, and escalating unacknowledged incidents.
2. **On-Call Rotation Management**
Covers creating, updating, and viewing on-call rotation schedules with primary and secondary engineers.
3. **Incident Post-Mortem Management**
Covers recording and retrieving post-mortem information, including incident cause, impact, resolution, and follow-up actions.

III. Story and Story points

1. Incident Alert Handling

1.1 Receive Incident Alert

As a Monitoring System, I want to send incident alerts containing incident ID, severity, timestamp, and details, so that the incident can be recorded and routed.

Story Points: 3

1.2 Identify Active On-Call Engineer

As an Incident Management System, I want to identify the active primary on-call engineer from the current rotation schedule, so that the incident is assigned to the correct responder.

Story Points: 3

1.3 Dispatch Incident Notification

As an On-Call Engineer, I want to receive incident notifications through configured channels such as SMS, email, or webhook, so that I can quickly review and respond.

Story Points: 5

1.4 Acknowledge Incident

As an On-Call Engineer, I want to acknowledge an assigned incident, so that the system records responsibility and stops further escalation.

Story Points: 3

1.5 Escalate Unacknowledged Incident

As an Incident Commander, I want an incident escalated to the secondary engineer when the primary does not acknowledge within 5 minutes, so that critical incidents are not left unattended.

Story Points: 5

Epic Total: 19 Story Points

2. On-Call Rotation Management

2.1 Create On-Call Rotation

As an authorized user, I want to create a rotation schedule with primary and secondary engineers for defined shifts, so that the system knows who should receive incidents.

Story Points: 5

2.2 Update On-Call Rotation

As an authorized user, I want to update existing rotation schedules, so that changes in availability and shifts are reflected.

Story Points: 3

2.3 View On-Call Rotation

As an authorized user, I want to view the current rotation schedule, so that I can verify the assigned primary and secondary engineers.

Story Points: 2

Epic Total: 10 Story Points

3. Incident Post-Mortem Management

3.1 Record Incident Post-Mortem

As an Incident Commander, I want to record a post-mortem including cause, impact, resolution, and follow-up actions, so that the organization can learn from the incident.

Story Points: 3

3.2 Retrieve Incident Post-Mortem

As an Incident Commander, I want to retrieve a saved post-mortem using the incident ID, so that I can review previous findings and follow-up actions.

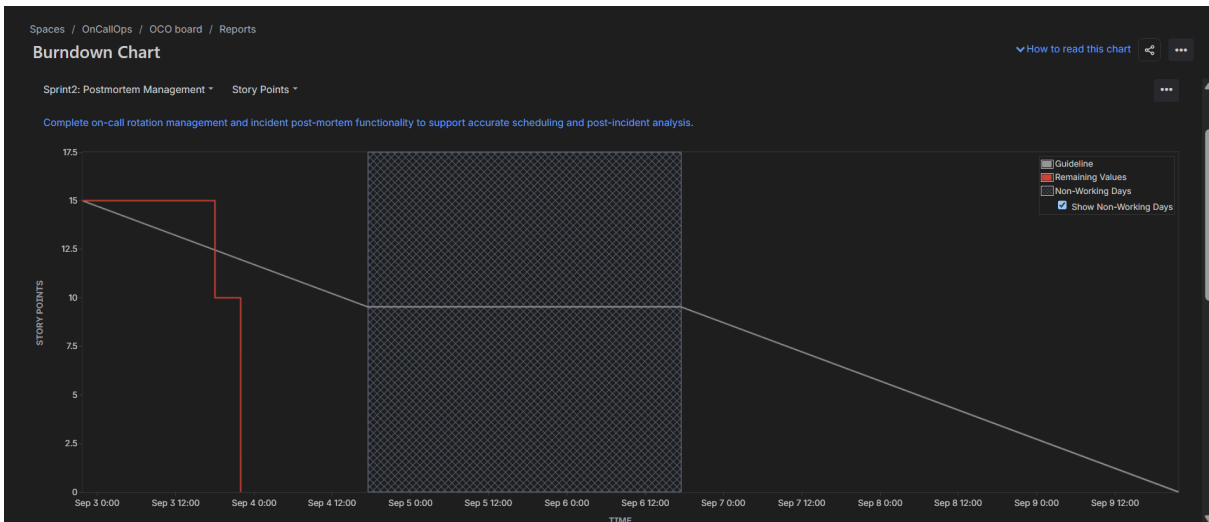
Story Points: 2

Epic Total: 5 Story Points

Total Story Points: 34

III. Burndown Charts

The Jira burndown chart was used to track the remaining story points throughout the sprint and visualize the team's progress toward completing the planned work.



Spaces / OnCallOps

OCO board

SummaryListActive sprintsBacklogDevelopmentFormsTimelineDocsReports

OCO-1

Epic 1: Incident Alert Handling

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Description

Manage the complete incident alert lifecycle, including receiving alerts from the monitoring system, identifying the active on-call engineer, dispatching notifications, recording acknowledgements, and escalating incidents when no acknowledgement is received within 5 minutes.

Attachments

Child work items

Work	Prio...	Stor...	Ass...	Status
OCO-4 Story 1.1: Receive Incident Alert	H..	3	Ur	Done
OCO-5 Story 1.2: Identify Active On-Call Engineer	H..	3	Ur	Done
OCO-6 Story 1.3: Dispatch Incident Notification	H..	5	Ur	Done
OCO-7 Story 1.4: Acknowledge Incident	H..	3	Ur	Done

To Do

Details Assignee, Reporter, Label...

Development

More fields Story Points, Original ...

Automation Rule executions

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Configure